

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Ice storm

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Avoid travel on icy roads and keep away from ice-laden trees and power lines. Prepare for a long outage using safe heat and battery lights. Stay indoors until conditions improve unless your shelter is unsafe.

Do now.

☐**Postpone travel**

01

Even thin ice can make roads and sidewalks unsafe.

☐**Avoid falling hazards**

02

Stay clear of branches, wires and roofs shedding ice.

☐**Use safe backup heat**

03

Keep combustion equipment outdoors and maintain working CO alarms.

☐**Check vulnerable people**

04

Plan safe transport to a warm location if heat or essential medical power fails.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Preserve heat in a dry room, keep lights battery powered and avoid unnecessary travel. If you must move because of dangerous cold, do it before people become weak and use a route you know is passable; a car is not reliable shelter if exhaust or roads are blocked.

Watch for.

Never touch or approach a fallen wire, even if it appears inactive.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Use footwear with traction for necessary movement and do not enter areas beneath damaged trees.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Ice storm · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/ice-storm/>